

eyecatchers

GETTING REAL

Actor **Swaroop Sampat** has been selected by Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi to head a unique educational programme for children. The programme will use drama as a tool. "We will teach students life-enhancing skills by dramatising real-life scenarios," says Sampat, a Ph.D. in education from Worcester University in England. Having worked with dyslexic children for some years, Sampat is working with a team of 30 teachers across the state.



SUBI SAMUEL

Sister Act

The last time they came together was to sing *Bahi jaiyo na rani bahi jayo na* for *Sabse Bada Rupaiya* in 1976. So this is a reunion everyone will love, especially Sai Baba devotees. Sisters **Lata**, 79, and **Usha Mangeshkar** (L), 73, have come together after three decades to record the album, *Shri Sai Ki Aartiyan*. It is a compilation by the nightingale's protégé Mayuresh Pai. "It is always nice to work with Didi," says Usha. Now, isn't this called defying age?



DEEPAK SALVI

CAMEO CAPER

Salman Khan and Preity Zinta's tractor romance in *Heroes* may be getting all the attention. But it doesn't mean Sunny Deol has been left without a love interest. Missing in action for long, **Hrishita Bhatt** will be seen in a special appearance. "The producer wanted me to do it," says Bhatt, who has *Friends Forever* and *Jugaad* up her sleeve.



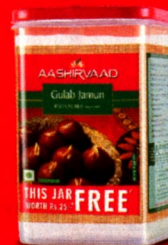
Calling the Shots

From ad films to international acclaim, **Kamal B. Yadav** has come a long way. The TV and ad film director recently bagged the Best Art Director Award at the San Francisco Short Film Festival for his film, *The Assassin*. The 16-minute film looks at the story of a poor youth being brainwashed by terrorists. "Suicide bombing is a global concern; so the film connects with an international audience," says the director. Yadav is now looking forward to directing a romantic comedy.



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